

A portrait of Lydia Maddix, a Black woman with short dark hair, smiling and holding a pink guitar. She is wearing a dark turtleneck and a patterned blazer. The background is a vibrant, colorful pattern featuring large circular motifs and butterflies in shades of blue, orange, and red.

INDIEFFERENTIAL

WHAT'S NEW?

by indiefferential

LYDIA MADDIX | WHAT'S NEW SEPTEMBER VOL .1

Lydia Maddix

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Do you remember that time you discovered your favorite band? What was that like? How did it feel? Over the years we have found different ways of discovering new music and other formats of entertainment. Some of you already remember the first time you bought a vinyl record or a CD.

For me, it was one of the best experiences when I bought an AC/DC CD freshly bought ready to be played at full volume in my parent's Hi-Fi system. The physical aspect of the release always was something that stayed with me for a long time and I loved the whole experience of having that CD, inserting it into the system, controlling the volume and listening to my favorite tracks over and over again. Everything that came along with the CD was a bonus, you could look at pictures, read about the band and have something to do while experiencing their music.

Right now most music is released in digital formats and you can't really experience this. Magazines were also something that introduced me to my favorite bands back in the day. I remember reading about the Killers long before listening to their hits on the radio. Still, the physical aspect of the discovery was significant, for me at least. Of course, it's a lot easier to find out great music these days and not buy seven different CDs to discover what you like.

Enough with the past though, let's move to today, you can stream music, films and series and many people don't bother buying magazines or CDs. I am one of these people who loves to collect things and I also own many video games in digital and physical format. Even though some of my favorite video games are in a library on my computer, I always cherish the time I take to look through the case of an older video game, its pamphlets and artwork.

This is one of the reasons we started Indiefferential. The experience of holding a physical magazine in your hands, reading about these new bands from the other side of the world while you listen to their music online sending them a DM that you love their work. This is what Indiefferential is all about, keeping the good aspects of physical releases and combining this experience with the modern opportunities technology provides.

Indiefferential is here for every artist out there, we love what we do and we will keep posting about your music and projects so people can find out their new favorite artist. **Our plan is to post consistently about new artists and creators, in that way, your audience will find out about another great band and their audience will discover your work. This is how Indiefferential works, always supporting artists in order to find the right audience and have their work sent across the whole world.**

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Garry Pitcairn: From Desert Isolation to Apocalyptic Rock: A Journey Through Sound and Survival

Born on a remote island in the heart of the Po Valley desert, Garry Pitcairn emerged from the ashes of his former band, Anubi, to carve out a singular musical path. His debut album, I'll See You In The Trees (2014), was a solitary labor of love, entirely written, played, mixed, and produced by Pitcairn himself, shaped by the stark, unforgiving desert landscape that fueled its raw emotional core. To bring his vision to life on stage, Pitcairn formed the Garry Pitcairn Orchestra, which laid the groundwork for his sophomore album The Gospel (2019).

Now Playing...

This record marked an evolution, blending desert rock's gritty textures and psychedelic undertones with brooding singer-songwriter introspection inspired by icons such as Michael Gira, Nick Cave, and Mark Lanegan. The album's atmospheric depth attracted the attention of renowned producer Alain Johannes, collaborator with Lanegan, Queens of the Stone Age, Chris Cornell, and PJ Harvey, who mixed the entire project, elevating Pitcairn's sound to a new cinematic intensity.

As the world darkened, so too did Pitcairn's outlook. Relocating to the vibrant yet chaotic cityscape of Rome to escape mysterious epidemic outbreaks, he forged a new creative alliance with local musicians Flavio Di Giuseppe (drums) and Gianluca Bonetti (bass). Together, they are crafting *Fiesta Forever*, a raw, apocalyptic songbook that channels the destructive power of Italian rock music like never before.

The lead single, "People Eat People," slated for release in September 2025, is a bold statement, two original tracks by Pitcairn plus a haunting live cover of a Portishead classic, designed to be experienced intimately on headphones while the world around you rages in celebration. This new chapter promises a haunting blend of survival, chaos, and relentless sonic exploration that redefines the boundaries of modern rock.



Exclusive Feature

Released on August 25, 2025, Biglari's rendition of "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera" isn't a straightforward cover. It is a thoughtful reimagining that honors the song's emotional weight while breathing new textures into its framework. Biglari handled the arrangement, guitar, and lead vocals from his home studio, grounding the project in both intimacy and independence. The decision to record in a personal space rather than a slick professional studio gives the track a warmth that feels hand-crafted, as though every note was shaped with care.



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Some songs are so timeless that they seem to exist outside of cultural and generational boundaries. Italian singer Peppino Gagliardi's "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera" is one of those pieces—a song heavy with romance, melancholy, and cinematic sweep, etched into memory through decades of radio play, film placements, and heartfelt performances. It takes courage to revisit a track so ingrained in history. For Vancouver-based artist Farbod Biglari, that challenge was exactly the point.

Released on August 25, 2025, Biglari's rendition of "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera" isn't a straightforward cover. It is a thoughtful reimagining that honors the song's emotional weight while breathing new textures into its framework. Biglari handled the arrangement, guitar, and lead vocals from his home studio, grounding the project in both intimacy and independence. The decision to record in a personal space rather than a slick professional studio gives the track a warmth that feels hand-crafted, as though every note was shaped with care.

The recording was further elevated through collaboration. Stefano Ferracin stepped in for mixing and mastering, ensuring the balance between old and new stayed intact, while Maria Duque's backing vocals weave delicately around Biglari's lead. The interplay between their voices brings a new layer of drama to the piece—faithful to the song's operatic roots, yet refreshingly modern in its restraint.

What makes this cover particularly striking is Biglari's use of rock-inspired elements to refresh the arrangement. Where Gagliardi's original leans on orchestral grandeur, Biglari introduces guitar-driven textures that add grit and tension to the melancholy core. The result is a sound that bridges eras: one foot firmly planted in the song's Italian heritage, the other exploring contemporary terrain. The fusion feels natural, not forced, and it highlights Biglari's ability to treat the material with reverence while still making it unmistakably his own.

For Biglari, the song isn't just a chance to showcase his vocal and instrumental skill—it's an opportunity to explore what it means to carry tradition forward. By choosing to reinterpret rather than replicate, he demonstrates a deep respect for Gagliardi's artistry while asserting his own voice. It's a delicate balancing act, but one that pays off: the track resonates with listeners who know the original while inviting a new audience into its orbit. The choice of "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera" also speaks to Biglari's artistic ethos.

for attention, Biglari's version stands apart for its care and conviction. It doesn't reduce the song to nostalgia or trendiness. Instead, it becomes a meditation on what makes certain pieces endure—and how artists can keep them alive not by freezing them in time, but by letting them evolve.

With "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera," Farbod Biglari has managed to honor a classic while pushing into new territory. The release is as much about his own artistic identity as it is about the song itself. By fusing rock textures with the emotional gravity of Italian balladry, he has created a piece that feels both rooted and forward-looking. It's a reminder that music's greatest gift is its ability to travel—across languages, across generations, across continents—and still find new life in the hands of artists willing to take risks.



Vocally, Biglari resists the temptation to imitate. Instead, his delivery carries a subdued power, his phrasing stretching the song's emotional pauses into moments of intimacy. There's an almost confessional tone in his performance, as if he is singing less to an audience and more to a single listener across the room. This intimacy is balanced by the broader sweep of the instrumentation, creating a push and pull between personal reflection and cinematic drama.

At its core, the song wrestles with longing and the unshakable presence of music as both comfort and torment. Biglari leans into those themes, layering his own modern sensibilities over the timeless sentiment. The result is more than just a cover; it's a dialogue between past and present, between Italy's mid-century romance and today's search for authenticity in an age of constant reinvention. In a musical landscape where covers can often feel like quick grabs

Farbod Biglari Reimagines an Italian Classic with "Che Vuole Questa Musica Stasera"



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here's something electric about a band that can take a well-worn mystery and make it feel alive again. With their latest single, "Secrets of Roswell," American Grim taps into the endless fascination with extraterrestrial lore and turns it into a storm of sound—cinematic, charged, and unflinchingly human. Released on May 11, 2025, the track isn't just a nod to the infamous UFO crash of 1947; it's a full-bodied exploration of fear, wonder, and obsession, wrapped in the band's unrelenting energy.

Hailing from Princeton, New Jersey, American Grim is built on the synergy of four distinct voices. Ryan Grim leads with vocals that swing between urgency and defiance. Brendan Healy anchors the chaos on drums, giving the music its heartbeat. Guitarist Michael Morello provides the grit and propulsion, while Maddie Veil's synth textures stretch the band's sound outward, sometimes celestial, sometimes sinister. Together, they create a musical universe that feels expansive yet tightly wound, a sound that carries both the punch of rock and the shimmer of something otherworldly.



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“Secrets of Roswell” captures this duality perfectly. From the opening measures, the track builds tension with layered instrumentation that mimics the unease of staring into the night sky, waiting for something to appear. Then it bursts open, guitars snarling, drums colliding, vocals cutting through with urgency. The lyrics wrestle with the myths and paranoia surrounding Roswell, but underneath, there’s a more universal theme: the human need to believe in something beyond ourselves, and the fear of what might happen if those beliefs prove true. It’s a song that thrives on contradiction—mystical but grounded, historical yet timeless.

The recording process only amplified the band’s chemistry. Tracked at guitarist Michael Morello’s own studio, the familiar setting allowed American Grim to lean into experimentation without losing their raw edge. You can hear that freedom in the way the track moves: tight but never sterile, deliberate yet alive with spontaneity. The band’s self-sufficiency has always been one of its strengths, and here it results in a piece of music that feels both carefully constructed and wildly immediate.

While the single draws on the lore of Roswell, its resonance stretches well beyond conspiracy theories and sci-fi narratives. It’s a reflection of cultural fascination with the unknown, the way societies project their hopes and anxieties onto mysteries they can’t fully explain. In that sense,

“Secrets of Roswell” isn’t just a song about aliens—it’s a meditation on curiosity, paranoia, and the edges of human imagination. In a crowded landscape where many acts aim to recycle rock tropes; stars metaphorically, American Grim has built a spacecraft of their own and invited listeners to climb aboard. The result is music that resonates on multiple frequencies: you feel it in your chest, you follow it in your mind, and you carry it with you long after the last note fades.

American Grim Unlocks the Unknown with “Secrets of Roswell”

losing touch with the human pulse beneath it. Ryan Grim’s vocals ache and soar, Maddie Veil’s synths bring a haunting shimmer, Brendan Healy drives the rhythm with relentless precision, and Morello’s guitar cuts through like a beacon. Each member contributes their own shade, and together, they form something far brighter than the sum of their parts. “Secrets of Roswell” is what happens when a band dares to go all in. As they continue to build their body of work, American Grim’s trajectory feels anything but earthbound. With “Secrets of Roswell,” they’ve proven not only their ability to tell stories that captivate but also their capacity to transform those stories into soundscapes that challenge and inspire. It’s a reminder that music, like the mysteries we chase, is most powerful when it leaves us with more questions than answers.



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AMERICAN GRIM



Grace Palmer Finds Strength in Vulnerability with “Breathe”

“Breathe” is not polished escapism; it is lived experience set to melody



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Music has long been a vessel for honesty, but few artists are willing to expose their most fragile moments as openly as Birmingham-based singer-songwriter Grace Palmer. With her latest single “Breathe”—released in April 2024—Palmer transforms her own struggles with anxiety into a song that resonates as both deeply personal and universally relatable. The track is not just a confessional piece; it’s a mental health anthem that extends a hand to anyone who has ever felt trapped in the relentless cycle of self-criticism and doubt. The origins of “Breathe” trace back to 2018, when Palmer found herself at a breaking point. Caught in the grip of perfectionism, shaken by heavy drinking on a holiday, and haunted by the anxiety that followed, she reached for her guitar as a lifeline. What came out was raw, immediate, and unfiltered. “I had always struggled with expecting myself to be perfect,” she recalls.

“After a difficult couple of weeks where I was beating myself up over something that didn’t align with my values, my anxiety became relentless. Writing ‘Breathe’ was like a release—it poured out in minutes.” What began as a cathartic moment in her bedroom grew into something much larger. Sharing the song at a songwriting class at Birmingham’s MAC Arts Centre, Palmer moved her tutor so profoundly that he offered his home studio—a modest space with only a microphone, piano, and a leaking roof—to record her vocals. This rough session became the foundation of the track, capturing the raw emotion that still pulses through the final version. From there, “Breathe” took shape in collaboration with producer Scott Ralph, whose work is known for amplifying vulnerability without diluting its impact. The two had first crossed paths at a wedding and reconnected musically for Palmer’s

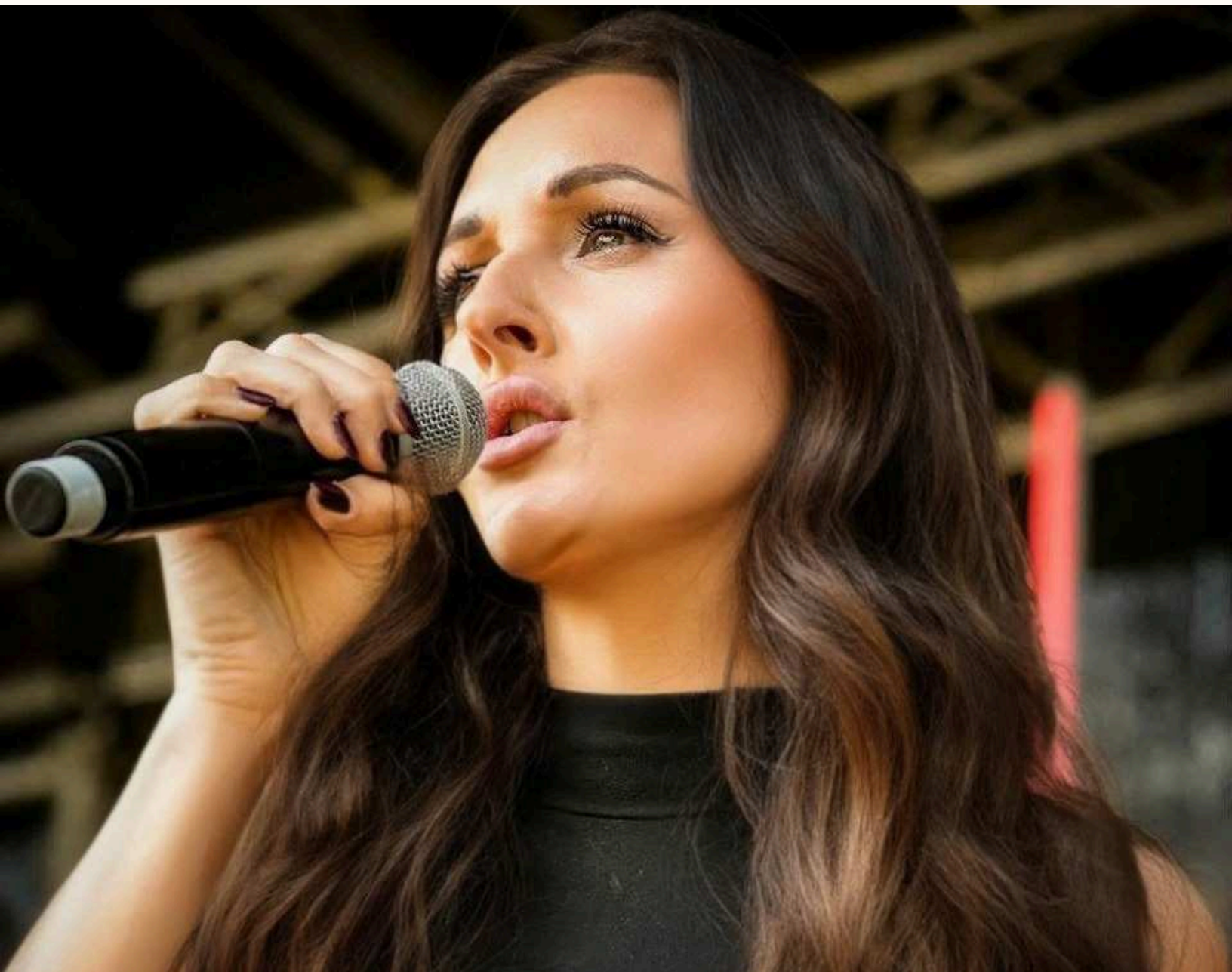
debut single. Their partnership deepened in Ralph’s Stoke-on-Trent studio, where his ability to frame Palmer’s voice with sensitivity and restraint allowed the song to retain its intimacy while gaining polish. “Scott and I really vibe in the studio,” Palmer says. “He just gets it—he knows how to keep the heart of the song intact while making it shine.” The song’s impact was immediate. Listeners have reached out to share how “Breathe” made them feel seen, less alone, and more hopeful in their own battles with mental health. That sense of connection is exactly what Palmer hoped to achieve. “There’s a mental health crisis happening, and I want people not to feel alone,” she explains. “This song is about hope—about remembering that if you can just carry on, everything will be okay.”

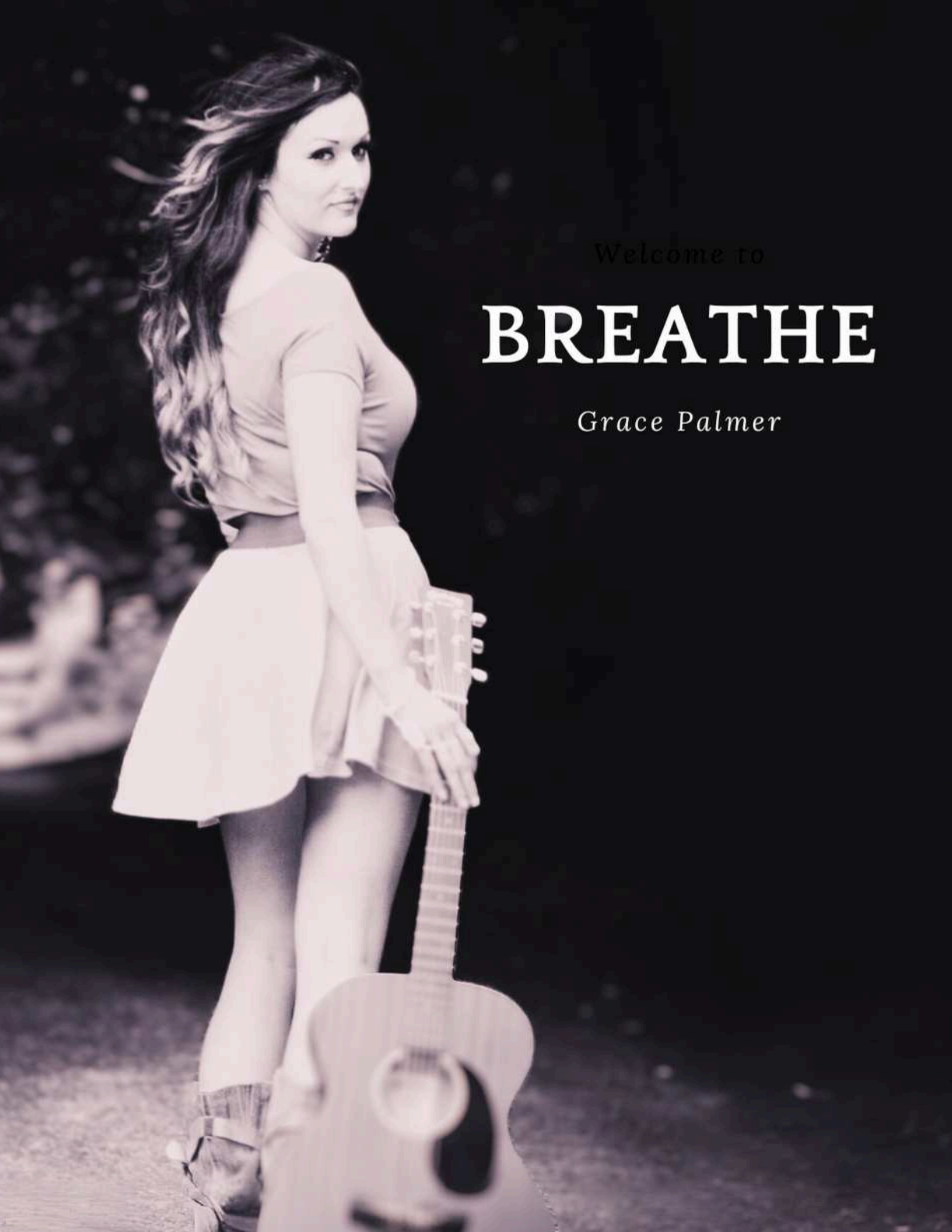
As conversations around mental health continue to grow louder, Palmer's voice feels both timely and necessary.

The authenticity of Palmer's storytelling has already earned "Breathe" radio play across both the UK and the USA, an impressive feat for only her second single. But beyond metrics and exposure, what sets her apart is the emotional courage embedded in her work. She doesn't shy away from her imperfections; instead, she leans into them, turning vulnerability into strength. Palmer's artistry is rooted in a belief that music can be both mirror and balm. By capturing the moment of collapse and pairing it with a message of resilience, she creates songs that are more than entertainment—they are lifelines.

With "Breathe," Grace Palmer has given us more than a single. "She has given us a reminder: to pause, to breathe, and to trust that brighter days lie ahead."

"Breathe" is not polished escapism; it is lived experience set to melody, proof that even in the depths of struggle, creativity can illuminate a path forward. As conversations around mental health continue to grow louder, Palmer's voice feels both timely and necessary. With each release, she is carving out a space for honest storytelling in a music industry that often favors gloss over grit. She represents a new generation of artists unafraid to speak their truths, and in doing so, she offers listeners not just songs, but solidarity.



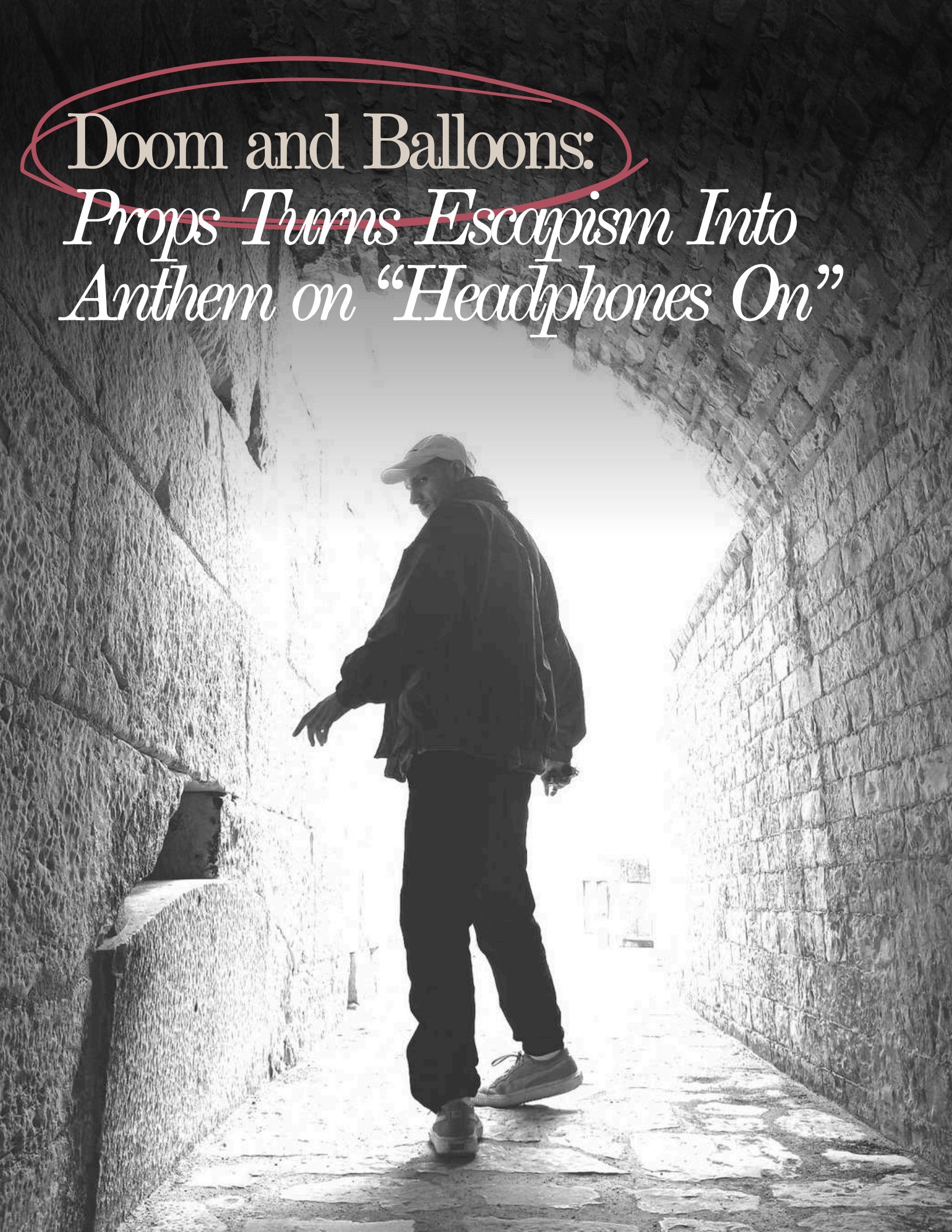


Welcome to

BREATHE

Grace Palmer

Doom and Balloons:
*Props Turns Escapism Into
Anthem on “Headphones On”*



indifferent exclusive

The opening line of Props' new single, "Headphones On," could be mistaken for a throwaway about zoning out to Spotify, but the song quickly reveals itself as something sharper, funnier, and more unsettling. It's a track about the peculiar tension of living in an era where climate dread, political chaos, and the endless churn of the news cycle are inescapable and yet, somehow, you still end up scrolling Twitter and cranking the volume on a playlist. Props takes that contradiction and spins it into a dizzying indie-pop rush that's as catchy as it is conflicted.

On the surface, "Headphones On" is everything you want in an indie banger: a sugar-shot chorus that refuses to leave your head, swaggering drums that could level a room, and a fizzing sense of euphoria that masks the darker currents underneath. The trick is in the sleight of hand. While the song delivers all the joy of escapism, the lyrics poke at the very idea of tuning out as the world burns. It's both a release valve and a mirror, holding up our own complicity with a smirk. Rupert Murdoch gets name-checked, kids scream for the trees, and slacktivism gets skewered in a way that feels biting but never heavy-handed. It's protest music for the generation that can't quite drag itself to the picket line.

Musically, Props sits in a strange and alluring pocket. Imagine MGMT in a therapy session, or The Strokes sobering up after the party. The melodies are buoyant, but the mood carries a knowing weariness, like balloons tied to a weight. It's what Props themselves call "doom and balloons"—a refusal to wallow, but also a refusal to look away. The tension between those poles is what makes the track stick. Where some bands might lean into despair or irony, Props finds a way to keep the groove alive while still pointing at the absurdity of it all.

The path to this moment has been anything but straightforward. Props was born out of experiments in a Scottish rental cottage, where Ableton presets collided with makeshift percussion using mugs-as-drums. That playful, DIY spirit carried them through a decade of indie band backlines, existential dread, and the kind of persistence that seems to define artists who refuse to stop chasing the sound in their heads.

Their 2022 mixtape songs cracked open doors to BBC 6 Music, Radio 1, Elton John's Rocket Hour, and a scattering of tastemaker platforms like Clash, Wonderland, and Spotify's Fresh Finds. The music even slipped its way onto Made in Chelsea, proof that Props' blend of oddball sincerity and sticky hooks resonates beyond the underground.

Now based in South London, Props splits time between music and community-led climate projects, a balance that feels like the engine behind the new material. There's a push and pull between activism and escapism, noise and silence, dread and joy. That tension is written all over the upcoming EP, pointedly titled *put your money where your mouth is*. Across three tracks and a bonus intro, Props charts a sprint through euphoria, cynicism, and optimism, in that order. If "Headphones On" is the soundtrack to ducking reality, the rest of the EP asks the harder question: what happens when you finally take the headphones off?

Props' new work doesn't try to resolve the contradictions of our time, and that's exactly why it hits. It thrives in the in-between space, acknowledging that sometimes the most honest response to the chaos is to laugh, dance, and keep making noise, even if it's just long enough to get through the day. "Headphones On" isn't just an indie-pop earworm; it's a slyly profound anthem for a generation trying to find lightness without losing its edge. Doom and balloons, indeed.



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In an age where every ping of a notification feels like another weight added to the mind, Thomas O'Shea has found a way to turn that noise into music. The Wisconsin-based producer, songwriter, and audio engineer has spent years behind the boards experimenting with sound, chasing textures, and shaping beats that blur the edges of genre. His new solo single, "Polar Night," is a culmination of that journey: a song that channels the unease of constant news cycles and digital exhaustion while still finding space for beauty and release.

O'Shea's career has been defined by curiosity and reinvention. Based in Madison, his productions are as likely to pull from the glossy sheen of pop as they are to dip into the grit of hip hop or the pulse of EDM. At the core is an instinct for building music from unexpected places—field recordings, odd samples, and unconventional sounds that he bends into something both crisp and immersive.

With a degree in Audio Production and Music Business, he brings a craftsman's precision to everything he makes, ensuring that even the strangest sonic choices land with clarity and impact.

That meticulous approach has already taken him far. He has worked alongside Billboard-charting producers, contributed across a spectrum of genres from rock to classical, and seen his name appear in outlets like Cage Riot Music, 9Lounges, ProducerCulture, and Indie Radio. His remixes and releases have reached hundreds of thousands of listeners worldwide, proof that his eclectic vision resonates beyond the studio walls.



feature

Thomas O'Shea's "Polar Night" Turns Information Overload Into Art



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Still, O'Shea's new solo work feels like a turning point, a moment where his technical expertise and artistic impulses converge with striking urgency.

"Polar Night" captures that energy. The track is anchored by a sense of shadow and tension, a reflection of what it feels like to be surrounded by a constant stream of headlines and alerts. Yet O'Shea doesn't let the weight of the theme collapse the song. Instead, he leans into contrast. Lush layers glide over taut rhythms, while his lyrics unfold in a way that feels less like a lecture and more like a release of pressure.

"Once I produced it and started on lyrics, the words just started flowing out," O'Shea explains. That immediacy can be felt in every line. What makes the track compelling is its openness. While "Polar Night" was born from the exhaustion of information overload, O'Shea deliberately leaves space for listeners to project their own meanings onto it. Some will hear it as a meditation on negativity in the world, others as an expression of isolation or even resilience. That elasticity is what he sees as the heart of his art: the ability for music to shift depending on who holds it, like a mirror that reflects differently for each person who looks into it.



The release also points to where O'Shea is headed. He's no longer content to stay in the background as just a producer or engineer. His solo project is about claiming his voice, threading together the many influences he's absorbed over the years into something unmistakably his own. It's pop, but skewed; hip hop, but reshaped; EDM, but more expansive. Above all, it's personal.

Thomas O'Shea may be rooted in Madison, but his sound feels built for the wider world. With "Polar Night," he has crafted a track that doesn't simply echo the chaos of modern life but reframes it, finding rhythm and resonance in the noise. It's the kind of song that lingers not because it offers easy answers, but because it understands the questions we're all carrying. In doing so, O'Shea affirms his place not just as a versatile producer but as an artist worth listening to in his own right.





indiefferential exclusive

There's a certain thrill—and exhaustion—that comes with scrolling through social media and watching someone else's relationship unravel in real time. We all know the posts: cryptic captions, subtweets that aren't really subtle, filtered selfies layered over raw confessionals. It's messy, it's performative, and it's everywhere. Emerging artist Lydia Maddix takes this modern-day spectacle and flips it into a sharp, infectious anthem with her new single “Dirty Laundry,” out June 23rd, 2025.

Lydia Maddix Turns Social Media Meltdown Into Indie-Pop Gold with “Dirty Laundry”

Recorded in producer Jack Segal's bedroom studio, “Dirty Laundry” thrives on its imperfections, embracing the rawness of indie-pop and indie-rock with jangly guitars and a rhythm that feels both restless and immediate. Maddix cites The Kooks and Kate Nash as touchstones, and you can hear those influences woven through the track's playful yet biting energy. It's music that's as catchy as it is confrontational, the kind of song that burrows into your head while poking at the absurdities of digital life.



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At its core, the track is a candid critique of oversharing culture—the way couples perform their heartbreak online as though Instagram and TikTok were confession booths. “I wanted to write something that reflects how bizarre it is to see relationships unravel in real time online,” Maddix explains. “It's about the drama, the dysfunction, and the strange performance of it all.” Her delivery doesn't come across as cruel, though. Instead, it carries a wry sense of observation, the voice of someone who's both fascinated and bewildered by the public theater of private collapse.



The brilliance of “Dirty Laundry” lies in how it balances sharp commentary with undeniable pop instincts. The hook is addictive, but there’s grit beneath the gloss. Maddix doesn’t just poke fun at oversharing—she captures the uneasy voyeurism of scrolling through other people’s heartbreak, that mix of discomfort and intrigue that keeps us from looking away. It’s a song that reflects the scroll itself: funny, messy, and just a little tragic. Maddix’s ability to thread honesty through her work is what makes her stand out among the growing wave of indie-pop voices. There’s a conversational edge to her lyricism, reminiscent of early Kate Nash, that feels like she’s letting you in on the joke while also pointing out the cost of it. The production, kept close to its bedroom roots, resists over-polish, which only strengthens the song’s bite. This isn’t an algorithmic pop single designed for background playlists—it’s a track meant to make you nod, smirk, and maybe reflect on your own online habits. In a time when the line between authenticity and performance has blurred to near invisibility, Maddix offers a rare kind of clarity. “Dirty Laundry” doesn’t moralize or preach—it simply holds up a mirror and dares us to take a closer look. The result is a song that feels both timely and timeless, a document of how relationships, drama, and attention-seeking now live permanently online.

With this release, Maddix is making her case as one of the more observant new voices in indie-pop, unafraid to tackle the cultural quirks most of us accept without question. If her debut single was an introduction, “Dirty Laundry” is a statement: Lydia Maddix is here to turn the noise of the oversharing age into songs that stick.



Photo by Antonin Le Hutin

Some songs arrive fully dressed for the stage. Others feel like they're whispering secrets across a dimly lit room. Silky Vibe's latest single, "Mess With Me," belongs firmly in the second camp. Released on August 26, 2025, the track drifts into the listener's space like a late-night confession, balancing soulful vocals and tender guitar lines with just enough grit to keep it from floating away. It's the kind of song that lingers, not because it shouts, but because it feels like it was made with no one else in the room. Silky Vibe, the Fort Lauderdale-based artist, songwriter, and producer behind the track, has carved out a sound that leans into vulnerability without losing its polish. His approach is unhurried, more about atmosphere than spectacle, drawing on personal experiences to shape lyrics that sting with honesty. At the heart of "Mess With Me" is a tension between fragility and defiance, a recognition of the ways intimacy can bruise as much as it heals. The guitar-driven arrangement underscores that mood perfectly: acoustic strums softened by a haze of electric undertones, live drums that give the song a pulse, and vocals that echo just enough to feel like they're bouncing around the walls of your own head. The result is a track that feels bedroom-born yet fully realized, raw but not rough. There's a dreamy undertow in the production, but the emotions never slip into vagueness. Instead, Silky Vibe manages to pin down a feeling that's hard to name—somewhere between longing and confrontation, between desire and the fear of being undone by it. In doing so, he delivers a listening experience that resonates on first play but deepens with each return.

"Mess With Me" also signals the growing arc of Silky Vibe's career. It arrives as the second release from his upcoming Moody EP, following the title track that introduced audiences to his knack for pairing emotive storytelling with carefully sculpted soundscapes. Where "Moody" hinted at his ability to stretch across different textures, "Mess With Me" leans inward, sharpening the focus on intimacy and emotional weight.

overproduction. That balance—between tradition and reinvention, softness and strength—points to a creative identity that's still unfolding but already compelling. If "Mess With Me" is any indication, Silky Vibe isn't just releasing songs; he's sketching out a world. One where the edges blur, emotions swell and recede, and listeners are invited to sit in the quiet corners of the music. It's an ambitious vision for an artist still

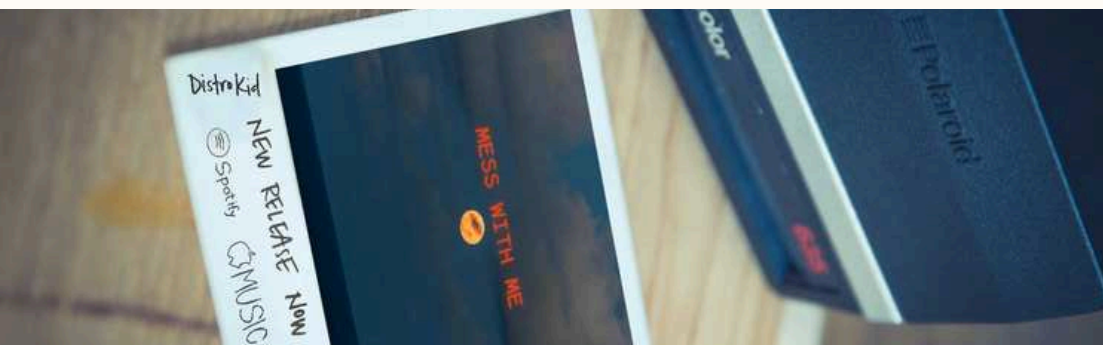
Silky Vibe Finds Intimacy and Edge on "Mess With Me"

Taken together, the two tracks suggest an artist capable of balancing range with cohesion, threading different moods into a single narrative voice. Silky Vibe's artistry lies in his ability to blend nostalgia with immediacy. There are shades of classic soul and R&B in his delivery, but the framing feels distinctly modern. Rather than chase polish for its own sake, he lets the imperfections breathe, giving the song a human warmth that's often lost in

at the start of his journey, but the confidence and clarity already present in his work suggest he's building toward something lasting. With the Moody EP on the horizon, Silky Vibe is poised to keep expanding that world—song by song, mood by mood.



**Listen
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The Lillypillies Invite Listeners to “Teleport Back” Through Memory and Melody



There is a rare kind of music that feels like it exists in two times at once: rooted in the present, yet carrying the weight and warmth of memory. Sydney-based indie-pop quartet The Lillypillies achieve that duality with their third album, *Teleport Back*, released on August 1, 2025. From the first shimmering guitar note to the last lingering refrain, the record unfolds as both a journey and a reflection, a soundscape of nostalgia, hope, and the persistent pull of human connection.

The Lillypillies have long been known for their ability to balance melodic immediacy with lyrical depth. On *Teleport Back*, that balance is sharpened and expanded. Lead vocalist and songwriter Manny Attanasio describes the album as “a time machine for the heart.” Indeed, the songs traverse the complex emotional geography of revisiting memories, confronting what has changed, and realizing how far one has come. Each track carries the weight of personal reflection without ever becoming heavy-handed, creating a listening experience that feels intimate and cinematic all at once.

The album’s sonic palette is lush yet finely tuned. Atmospheric production cloaks the band’s trademark jangly guitar lines, while Attanasio’s voice cuts through with warmth and clarity. Live drums and subtle synth layers add texture, creating depth without crowding the songs’ emotional core. Across the record, The Lillypillies demonstrate a versatility that keeps the listener engaged: soaring anthems give way to tender ballads, each composition crafted to evoke a specific moment or feeling. Tracks like *Don’t Leave Me Broken* and *All Around The World* exemplify this cinematic quality, carrying melodies that feel like snapshots of a memory you can almost touch, while

Take Me Home finds its strength in intimacy, already resonating widely on streaming platforms. Lyrically, *Teleport Back* is both personal and universal. Attanasio’s songwriting delves into the longing and resilience that come with human connection—the desire to hold onto what matters, to understand the past, and to move forward with clarity. The album’s narrative arc is subtle, never literal; it doesn’t dictate emotions, but instead provides a space for listeners to revisit their own moments of joy, heartbreak, and growth. There’s a storytelling sensibility here reminiscent



of classic indie-pop acts, yet firmly contemporary in its attention to sonic detail and emotional honesty. The album also marks a clear evolution in The Lillypillies’ sound. While maintaining the melodic hooks and poetic lyricism that have drawn listeners to their work, *Teleport Back* expands the band’s emotional and musical range. The album also marks a clear evolution in The Lillypillies’ sound. While maintaining the melodic hooks and poetic lyricism that have drawn listeners to their work, *Teleport Back* expands the band’s emotional and musical range. It’s

simultaneously a progression and a homage—a love letter to long-time fans and an accessible entry point for new listeners. The care with which each track is produced suggests a band comfortable with its identity, yet eager to push beyond familiar territory. At a time when pop and indie music often prioritize immediacy over resonance, The Lillypillies remind us of the enduring power of emotional storytelling. *Teleport Back* is more than a collection of songs; it’s an immersive journey that invites reflection without nostalgia becoming a weight, that celebrates growth while

honoring what we carry with us. Listening to the album, it’s easy to understand why the band has cultivated a loyal following: they create music that feels alive, honest, and deeply human. With *Teleport Back*, The Lillypillies prove that indie-pop can be both introspective and expansive, personal and universal, intimate and cinematic. It’s a record designed for the headphones and the late-night drive, for moments of reflection as well as collective listening.

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The Theos Variant
Beacons



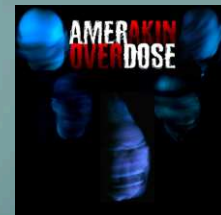
DESU TAEM
Sulfuric Acid Bath



The Beat Generation
Take Care of Yourself



Jack Horton
Never Know Why
(feat. Vesper Stockwell)



Amerakin Overdose
Nothing (Without You)



Cutterred Flesh
The King In Yellow



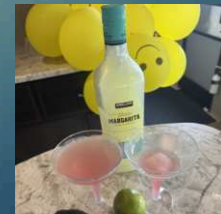
NightHawkX
Fire Fall



DUPLEXITY
Love In Reverse



The Beat Generation
Midnight Blues (生の情熱)



Philly and Suzy
Keep The Fire Burning

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interviews releases art films

Silk Daisys Turn Jangle-Pop Nostalgia into Bittersweet Charm with “It’s A Laugh”

There’s a certain magic in music that manages to feel both familiar and surprising, a sound that sparks childhood memories while wrapping them in a fresh, modern sheen. Atlanta duo Silk Daisys accomplish just that with their new single “It’s A Laugh,” released August 8, 2025. A glittering, bittersweet anthem of jangly guitars, handclaps, and sardonic smiles, the track navigates the delicate space between effervescent pop joy and melancholy undertones, evoking influences like The Primitives, The Go-Go’s, and the archetype of the sad clown.

Founded by James Abercrombie and Karla Jean Davis, Silk Daisys has been a quiet presence for years, with Abercrombie releasing material under the name on SoundCloud long before the duo formally shared music publicly. Yet “It’s A Laugh” crystallizes their decades-long creative collaboration, capturing both the duo’s musical chemistry and their playful, deeply personal approach to songwriting.

Abercrombie’s inspiration was to craft a song in the vein of early 80s jangle-pop classics like Crash or Do You Have To Break My Heart?, complete with a 12-string guitar solo that carries the kind of bright, ringing energy that instantly evokes nostalgia.

But the track’s appeal isn’t just in its shimmering instrumentation. It’s a clever exploration of emotional contrast. Beneath the handclaps, upbeat rhythms, and cheerful melodies lies a thread of poignancy—a nod to the sad clown archetype, that age-old tension between outward joy and inward melancholy. “I also love happy sounding songs about being sad,” Abercrombie says, acknowledging the subtle irony that makes “It’s A Laugh” feel both joyful and bittersweet at once.

The recording process was equally intimate and collaborative. Produced with Damon Moon at Standard Electric Recorders in Atlanta, the track features contributions from friends and family, including handclaps from their children, adding a sense of warmth and spontaneity. Karla’s lead vocals bring a sparkling, nuanced energy to the track, balancing the 80s-inspired jangle with a personal color all her own. The song’s abrupt “ha ha ha ha” ending, a playful addition from Karla, perfectly encapsulates the duo’s sense of humor and musical whimsy.



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Beyond the single, “It’s A Laugh” reflects the broader ethos of Silk Daisys: a project steeped in years of quiet creativity, personal storytelling, and collaborative experimentation. The duo recorded their debut album over a focused two-week period, a time they describe as “music camp every day,” trading riffs, refining ideas, and capturing a sense of joy and freedom that permeates the music. Even with Karla recording in a studio for the first time, the environment fostered confidence, creativity, and a sense of play that translates directly into the record.

The production polish further enhances the track’s appeal. Mixed by Troy Stains and mastered by Mark Gardener of Ride, the song balances clarity and sparkle with the emotional intimacy at its core. It’s an indie-pop gem that invites repeated listening, revealing new details and textures with each play, while remaining immediately accessible and catchy.

At its heart, Silk Daisys is also a story of personal connection. Many of the songs, including “It’s A Laugh,” are love letters to one another, artifacts of a long partnership that spans decades. That personal investment gives the music a depth that resonates beyond its infectious hooks. It’s joyful yet grounded, whimsical yet sincere—a rare combination in contemporary indie pop.

With “It’s A Laugh,” Silk Daisys prove that age, experience, and quiet persistence can yield a sound both nostalgic and fresh, intimate and expansive. It’s a track that celebrates jangle-pop’s playful energy while reminding listeners that even in the happiest songs, a hint of melancholy adds richness, texture, and emotional resonance.

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There is a rare energy that comes from music made without compromise, from songs born not from formula but from a deep desire to communicate. Eyal Erlich has found that energy, turning personal honesty into music that resonates far beyond his home city. With a string of online singles already accumulating hundreds of thousands of plays, Erlich is carving out a space where vibrant melodies, inventive arrangements, and heartfelt storytelling converge, drawing listeners into a soundscape both intimate and expansive. Erlich's approach is refreshingly direct. His songs carry a humility and sincerity that make them feel lived-in, like conversations you stumble into rather than performances staged for an audience.



Eyal Erlich Crafts a Global Voice with Soul and Sincerity

Soulful melodies, unexpected sonic textures, and lyrical moments that feel effortlessly relatable define his style. Yet underneath the immediacy of his music lies an ambitious creativity. Each track experiments with form and instrumentation in ways that keep the listener engaged, balancing accessibility with subtle

innovation. Whether leaning into stripped-back vocals over guitar or layering intricate harmonies with synths, Erlich manages to blend authenticity and imagination in a way that feels organic.

What sets Erlich apart is the connection he fosters with his audience. His lyricism touches on universal experiences, love, doubt, self-discovery, without ever losing its personal edge. The result is music that feels like it belongs to everyone and no one at once: intimate enough to feel like a confession, expansive enough to invite listeners into their own reflections.

It's no surprise that his online releases have sparked a growing global following, with fans drawn to both his vocal warmth and the playful unpredictability of his arrangements. The year ahead promises to be pivotal for Erlich. 2025–26 marks a period of growth and ambition, with plans for extensive touring that will bring his music overseas and a debut full-length album in the works.

From new singles and videos to live performances that highlight his dynamic stage presence, Erlich is not simply producing music—he's creating an experience. There's a sense of immediacy and excitement in his trajectory, a feeling that each song is part of a broader journey that he wants to share with listeners directly. Despite the growing scale of his career, Erlich's music remains grounded in human connection.

The vibrant textures and imaginative structures of his songs never overshadow their emotional core; if anything, they enhance it. Listeners can hear the thought, care, and personality woven into every melody, every lyric, every note. There's a generosity to his work, a desire not just to entertain but to communicate, to make his audience feel seen and heard.

Eyal Erlich's path feels emblematic of a new generation of artists who balance local roots with global reach. From Tel Aviv's vibrant creative scene, he is projecting a sound that transcends borders, one that is both playful and soulful, intricate yet immediately engaging. With a growing catalog of singles and the promise of a debut album, his voice is poised to make a lasting impression on the international music scene.

In a landscape where music can sometimes feel transactional or pre-packaged, Erlich's authenticity is striking. Every note, every lyric, every inventive arrangement carries the weight of intention and the joy of exploration. For fans discovering him online or preparing to catch him live, the promise is clear: Eyal Erlich is building more than a career—he is creating a shared musical adventure, inviting listeners into a world where sincerity and imagination meet in every song.



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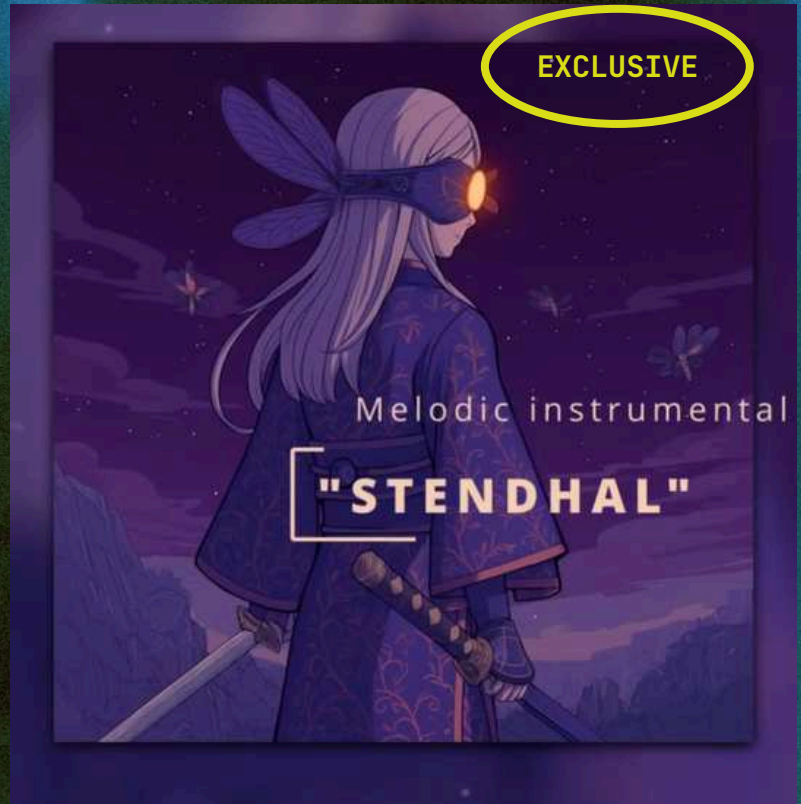
MYOKAMI CRAFTS INTIMATE INSTRUMENTAL WORLDS WITH “STENDHAL”

There is a quiet power in music that doesn't need words, where melody and emotion speak for themselves. Italian producer Alessandro Cataldo, known professionally as Myokami, has long embraced this idea, transforming his training and imagination into instrumental journeys that feel deeply personal and vividly cinematic. His latest single, “Stendhal,” released on August 29, 2025, continues this exploration, offering listeners an intimate, immersive soundscape that lingers long after the track ends.

Hailing from Avellino, Italy, Myokami brings a formal musical background to his independent artistry, holding a master's degree from the Conservatory of Benevento “Nicola Sala.” Yet despite his classical training, he thrives in an experimental and self-contained production environment. “Stendhal” was recorded entirely in his own room using VST instruments, a testament to his ingenuity and resourcefulness. The track's heart is the violin, which guides the listener through soft, meditative melodies interwoven with subtle textures reminiscent of nature, creating a sense of both serenity and expansive wonder.

Influenced by Lorien Testard of Expedition 33, Myokami draws on literary and musical narratives alike, using sound to tell stories without a single word. In “Stendhal,” he channels the emotions of Maelle, a character from Expedition 33, crafting melodies that feel like a journey through both the human psyche and the natural world. Improvisation played a central role in the composition, as Cataldo experimented with chord progressions and violin lines until the delicate balance of calm and wilderness was achieved. The result is a track that feels simultaneously organic and meticulously composed, intimate and expansive.

The beauty of Myokami's work lies in its emotional immediacy. Listeners are drawn into a world where each phrase of the violin, each carefully layered harmonic texture, carries meaning. The track's understated complexity allows it to unfold gradually, rewarding repeated listens with new discoveries in phrasing, instrumentation, and mood. There is an almost meditative quality to “Stendhal,” yet it is never passive; it engages, prompts reflection, and evokes vivid imagery without dictating interpretation.



Beyond the technical skill and compositional depth, there is a clear sense of intention behind Myokami's music. His use of the quote “Tomorrow comes” as a recurring motif encapsulates both the persistence of creativity and the emotional trajectory of his work: forward-looking, hopeful, and contemplative. It's a subtle reminder that, for Myokami, music is not only a craft but a narrative vessel capable of conveying complex human experiences. “Stendhal” has already begun to capture attention online, drawing viewers on platforms like YouTube and gaining recognition among curators seeking music that

combines sophistication with emotional resonance. It is a track that demands focus, inviting listeners to inhabit its world fully, whether for quiet reflection, study, or immersive listening. In an era dominated by high-energy, lyric-driven songs, Myokami's instrumental approach stands out for its bravery and singularity.



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JACK AGDUR EXPLORES LOSS, DISCOVERY, AND MUSICAL VERTIGO IN "TEMPORAL SINGULARITY"

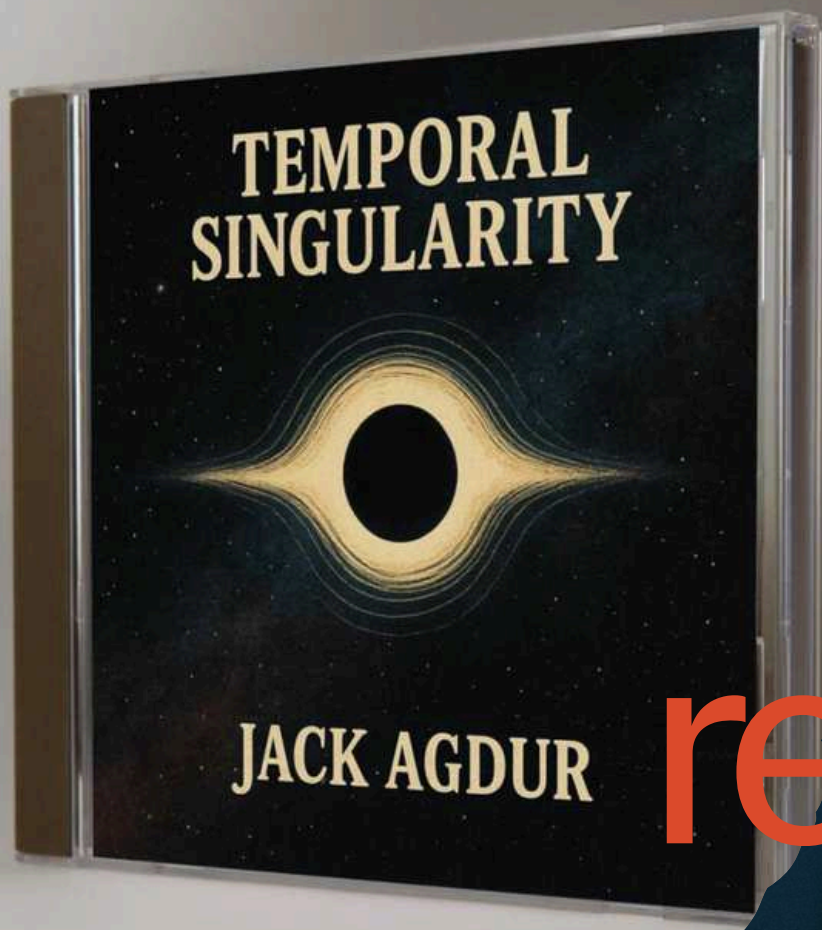
There is a rare kind of composition that exists at the intersection of intellect and emotion, where structure and feeling intertwine so seamlessly that the listener is simultaneously challenged and comforted. Jack Agdur, the composer and music educator, achieves this in his latest track, Temporal Singularity. The piece, a masterful blend of melodic clarity and harmonic depth, invites listeners to drift into a space where loss, reflection, and possibility coexist, a sonic experience both cerebral and profoundly human.

Emotionally, Temporal Singularity moves between the ache of loss and the quiet reassurance that it is never too late to revisit and explore what was once glimpsed. Agdur's work is not confined to the studio. He has collaborated with performance ensembles such as PRZ and the British dance company Meta4, experiences that have deepened his understanding of music as a collaborative, spatial, and kinetic art form. Temporal Singularity exemplifies Agdur's ability to marry technical sophistication with emotional resonance.

While the melodic contours are immediately compelling, the harmonic textures reveal themselves more slowly, rewarding careful listening. The piece reflects both his scholarly background and his intuitive artistry, a duality that gives the track its richness and depth. It is music that can be studied as much as it can be felt, offering layers of discovery on every play.



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**new
release**

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Emerging from the quiet of the UK lockdown, Sasha Sky has quickly established herself as a Northern singer-songwriter with a striking ability to turn vulnerability into song. Having loved music, poetry, and self-expression since childhood, she spent years wrestling with fear and anxiety before finally allowing her creativity to breathe. Studying Performing Arts and Music at New College Durham was the first step toward embracing her artistry beyond the classroom, and since 2021, she has been steadily carving out her space in the music world.

Sasha's sound is rooted in R&B, but her songwriting traverses genres, reflecting a restless curiosity and emotional honesty. Her sixth single, *Escape*, is a deeply personal work, two years in the making, that confronts the exhaustion of a relationship riddled with white lies, gaslighting, and repeated betrayal. The song pulses with raw frustration, yet beneath its tension lies a desire for liberation, a yearning to leave pain behind and find clarity.



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**"Escape" is
more than a
song; it is a
statement of
self-
preservation
and strength**

Sasha Sky: *Finding Voice Through Escape*

What makes Sasha compelling is her ability to translate private anguish into something universally felt. Her voice floats with a tender yet unwavering presence, carrying the listener through both the ache and the resolve of her lyrics. *Escape* is more than a song; it is a statement of self-preservation and strength, a testament to an artist willing to face the darkest corners of experience and turn them into something resonant, cathartic, and ultimately freeing.



Friendship Commanders: BEAR and the Art of Belonging

Nashville's Friendship Commanders continue to redefine heaviness with their latest dual single, *X / MIDHEAVEN*, leading up to the October 10 release of their new album *BEAR* on Magnetic Eye Records. Co-produced by the duo, Buick Audra on guitars and vocals, Jerry Roe on drums and bass, alongside longtime collaborator Kurt Ballou, *BEAR* explores the complex terrain of belonging, asking where it exists and where it is denied. The music carries the weight of doom and sludge while allowing moments of lightness and intimacy to emerge, creating a dynamic spectrum that reflects both sonic and emotional depth.

X is a tribute to a generation and a personal reflection on loss, written shortly after the passing of collaborator Steve Albini. Audra channels grief into a track that is mournful yet celebratory, honoring those who shaped their creative vision. The accompanying video, directed and edited by Roe, evokes the spirit of Gen X and '90s grunge, blending reverence with playful energy.

MIDHEAVEN shifts focus toward existential curiosity, questioning fate, identity, and the stars under which we are born. Instrumentally expansive, the track showcases the duo's chemistry, with moments where guitar and drums converse like voices in dialogue, propelling the listener through waves of intensity and release.

Critics have noted the band's ability to merge sludge-metal weight with melodic accessibility, and both *X* and *MIDHEAVEN* embody that balance. With ethereal vocals, crushing riffs, and an unmistakable creative vision, Friendship Commanders craft music that is heavy in sound yet expansive in thought. *BEAR* promises a collection that is simultaneously grounded and transcendent, an exploration of self, grief, and the search for connection in a world that often feels unmoored.



Indiefferential Picks

Some of the most interesting releases handpicked from our editorial team.



Dune Reaper: Blue-Collar Grit Meets Raw Rock in Forever Asleep

Burlington, Canada's Dune Reaper, the project of Hunter Murray and Nathanael Smith, channels the tension and resilience of everyday life into a sound that is at once unpolished and electrifying. Blending stoner rock, punk, and alternative metal, the duo crafts music that is raw, urgent, and distinctly their own. Their upcoming single, *Forever Asleep*, released on August 29, 2025, captures this ethos, turning personal struggle into a powerful sonic statement.

The track draws from the visceral energy of bands like Royal Blood and The Black Keys, translating themes of addiction, financial strain, and societal pressures into music that is as intense as it is relatable. Recorded at B Town Sound in Burlington with producer Justin Koop, the single balances vulnerability and force, each note steeped in authenticity.

Murray and Smith's blue-collar backgrounds inform the work, grounding their creative ambition in lived experience. *Forever Asleep* is both a cathartic release and a rallying cry, a declaration for anyone seeking freedom from routine and the courage to pursue their passions. Dune Reaper proves that music forged from grit and honesty can resonate with a wide audience, offering both intensity and a sense of shared human struggle.

Shorthanded: Unflinching Truth in I Can Tell You What A Woman Is

Shorthanded delivers a striking statement with *I Can Tell You What A Woman Is*, a track that brims with confidence, clarity, and unfiltered emotion. From the first note, the guitar leads carve their way through the mix, melodic yet commanding, setting a tone that is both urgent and captivating. The rhythm section propels the song forward, driving every verse and chorus with purposeful energy that complements the song's bold message.

Vocally, the performance is crisp and resonant, cutting through the instrumentation with precision while carrying a depth of feeling that makes the lyrics land with impact. The track balances technical skill with raw emotional honesty, creating a sound that is both engaging and thought-provoking.

Shorthanded's music thrives on this interplay between melody and momentum, honesty and musicianship, making *I Can Tell You What A Woman Is* a track that refuses to be ignored. It's an assertion of voice, identity, and creative freedom, a song that demands attention while leaving listeners anticipating what comes next.

Pags: Asserting Strength with Peace Ain't Cheap

With *Peace Ain't Cheap*, Pags stakes a claim on personal power, delivering a track that is as bold in its message as it is precise in its execution. The song emerges from a period of clarity, a moment when protecting energy and maintaining self-worth became non-negotiable, and that focus translates into every bar and beat. Unlike many contemporary tracks, the song relies on presence rather than profanity, proving that impact comes from intention as much as volume.

The production is cinematic yet minimal, allowing Pags' tight, melodic flows to cut through with effortless authority. It is a track built for resonance, one that has already found traction across international radio, blogs, and playlists spanning the U.S., Europe, Africa, and beyond. *Peace Ain't Cheap* lays the foundation for what listeners can expect from Pags' upcoming work, including the charting single *Monaco Gold*, showcasing an artist who blends sharp lyrical insight with controlled, dynamic delivery.



Spotify
Playlist

Swimming Pool: Liminal Moods and the Drift of Line Cuts

The Hague-Zürich duo Swimming Pool, composed of Kyla Shifroni and Seraina Fässler, continue to explore the spaces between sound and memory with their latest single, *Wednesday Kinda Weekend*, released alongside their debut EP *Line Cuts*. The track captures a late-summer haze, a drifting ballad that conjures citrus-scented air, lazy weekends, and a sun that never quite sets. Built on warped ambient textures, bowed bass, and layered vocals, *Wednesday Kinda Weekend* bends time and perspective, turning midweek into weekend and sunlight into mirage. Shifroni and Fässler trade delicate vocal fragments that hover without resolution, evoking longing that is both sonic and emotional.

Line Cuts expands on this vision, a five-track exploration of tension between clarity and distortion, intimacy and abstraction. From the whispered self-reflection of *Calling* to the ambient dissolution of *Once In A Blue Moon*, the EP dissolves conventional structures in favor of presence, mood, and subtle emotional drift. *Candle*, a reimagined Leonard Cohen cover, demonstrates their ability to deconstruct and rebuild emotional language through layered harmonies and bowed textures, signaling a meticulous yet instinctive approach to composition.

Surf O Rays: Golden-Hour Dreams in Talk Like Kids

Surf O Rays emerges as a surf-gaze project that effortlessly captures the sunlit nostalgia of coastal bliss while weaving it into a dreamlike, timeless atmosphere. Their latest single, *Talk Like Kids*, is a shimmering blend of vintage 12-string jangle and ethereal dream-pop textures, recalling the chiming harmonies of The Byrds and the tender introspection of Elliott Smith. Yet the track carries its own light, romantic glow, transforming familiar influences into something distinctly evocative and immediate.

Recorded entirely by Felix at Nashville's Divine Hum Studios, *Talk Like Kids* is lush with 60s-inspired harmonies, warm guitar tones, and celestial reverb that washes over each note like a gentle tide. The vocals hover with haunting intimacy, while the instrumentation balances nostalgia with a subtle sense of wonder, inviting listeners to drift along its breezy, reflective currents. This is music built for golden-hour drives, quiet evenings, and moments that linger in memory. Surf O Rays crafts soundscapes that feel both personal and expansive, marrying innocence and emotional depth into songs that resonate long after the last chord fades. *Talk Like Kids* is more than a track; it's a love letter to curiosity, youth, and the quiet magic of fleeting moments.



ANGEL RAPHAELS TOUCH



KAREN SALICATH JAMALI

Karen Salicath Jamali Channels Celestial Healing in “Angel Raphael’s Touch”

There are moments in music when sound transcends the ordinary, becoming a vessel for reflection, stillness, and renewal. Karen Salicath Jamali’s latest release, *Angel Raphael’s Touch*, inhabits that rare space, a piano composition that feels less like a song and more like a gentle conversation with the spirit. Born from a dream, the track draws inspiration from the energy of Archangel Raphael, the angel of healing, and translates that celestial essence into a sonic experience that is both tender and transformative.

Jamali describes the piece as emerging in the early morning hours, a time when her creative impulses are guided by the dream world. The result is a composition of serene simplicity, each note imbued with intention, each phrase carrying a sense of calm that invites the listener to pause, breathe, and reconnect with themselves. The track’s beauty lies not in complexity but in its clarity—its ability to evoke peace without relying on embellishment, offering a space for introspection and gentle restoration.

The production process further elevates the track’s impact. Jamali collaborated with Maria Triana, a mastering engineer whose credits span legends like Aretha Franklin, Bob Dylan, Sting, and the Metropolitan Opera. Triana’s touch preserves the purity of the piano while accentuating the ethereal qualities inherent in Jamali’s composition, allowing the healing energy to resonate with an unfiltered intimacy. The track is at once delicate and potent, a quiet assertion that music can be both art and medicine, capable of shifting mood and perception with a single chord.

In keeping with the song’s spiritual origins, the cover art for *Angel Raphael’s Touch* is equally striking. Jamali sculpted her own bronze representation of Archangel Raphael, a physical manifestation of the same dream that inspired the music. The sculpture and the composition exist in tandem, a multidimensional expression of a sacred vision. By merging visual and auditory art forms, Jamali creates a holistic encounter for the audience, one that blurs the boundaries between imagination, spirituality, and lived experience.



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What makes this work particularly compelling is the intention behind it. In a world that often prioritizes speed and distraction, Jamali offers an invitation to stillness. The track’s gentle arpeggios and flowing harmonic lines encourage a meditative state, allowing listeners to find a moment of personal sanctuary. There is a deliberate pacing to the piece, a rhythm that feels natural and restorative, echoing the energy of the angelic inspiration that birthed it.

Angel Raphael’s Touch is more than a single; it is a reflection of Jamali’s artistic philosophy—one in which music functions as a bridge between the celestial and the human, the imagined and the tangible. It exemplifies how personal vision, technical skill, and spiritual intention can converge to create a work that resonates far beyond its notes, offering a sense of serenity in an often chaotic world.

For those seeking music that restores, comforts, and uplifts, Jamali’s composition is a reminder of the quiet power of sound. Through the prism of dreams, devotion, and expert craftsmanship, *Angel Raphael’s Touch* carries a simple yet profound promise: a space to breathe, reflect, and reconnect with the gentle pulse of healing energy. It is a work that lingers in the heart long after the piano has fallen silent, a luminous testament to the transformative potential of music.

A conversation with KARNEY

Where can we find you right now and what are you up to?

You can find me on Facebook, Instagram, Bandcamp, Spotify, Apple Music, Amazon, and my website karney.org. Right now I am working on promoting One True Song, and resting. It was an intense year during the production of this album, lots of shows, and lots of life happenings. I am a choir director and guitar teacher, I have about 150 students every day, and while it is an incredibly fun and fulfilling job, it is also a very strenuous one. So I am taking time off right now.

ONE TRUE SONG showcases such a rich fusion of styles, from folk-rock to world rhythms. Tell us a bit about the creative process.

For the most part, the main idea of most of my songs comes to me all at once. That is a single lyric idea will come to mind set in its melody already. The vibe of the song is also part of that moment. Then I see if it actually works on the guitar, and if it does I start the process of sculpting a song. Some happen quickly, some are not done until I send the song to mastering. Throughout my songwriting life, many have advised me to choose a style and stick with it, but I have never felt the need to do that. Ideas are like my students, I don't play favorites, and I let them be who they are so they can develop into their most authentic selves.

You've worked with an impressive lineup of musicians on this album. What was it like collaborating with Bay Area legends like James Deprato, Uriah Duffy, and Phillip Bennet in one project?

All the musicians I work with are consummate professionals. Each one listens to my basic song ideas ahead of time and then shows up completely prepared with ideas they have already worked on. In the studio, they are positive and easy to work with. The most amazing thing about all the musicians, such as the ones you mention and bassist Kevin T. White, drummer Kyle Caprista, percussionist Faisal Zedan, and violinist Anthony Blea, they are all incredible artists in their own right. With rare exception, most songs are not just one person's idea, but the combination of artists contributing to a greater good.



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Songs like "Freedom Summer" and "Out of Body" touch on both social themes and spiritual ideas. Where do you usually draw the line between personal expression and activism in your songwriting?

I strive to be mindful of what the listener is experiencing, so I aim to strike a balance of topics on an album. It can be tough because, as I mentioned before, songs have a life of their own. That said, I might tweak an idea here or there so that the listener's ears don't tire out from me dwelling on something for too long.

You've been releasing music consistently since 1999. How do you keep your sound evolving while maintaining the core message of your artistry?

I listen to a really wide variety of music, from simple folk to symphonic music. I listen to music from North Africa and the Ivory Coast, Arabic music and South African music. I listen to Flamenco guitar, Mongolian heavy metal, and solo guitarists from around the world. I listen to very old music and very new music, always searching for a different approach.

My fascination with electronic music got me into writing for computer games and sound design, so I always have an ear out for that genre. There are some mind-blowing gospel singers, and gospel harmonies, and of course all the brilliant blues and blues-derived artists. I love the 20th-century composers who experimented with sound, rhythm, and arrangement. As for lyrics, I pay attention to the news and what is going on in the world; there is plenty to draw from there. I try to keep a fresh perspective in my own life as a growth-minded person. I don't think I will ever stop trying to discover new things; there is so much in the world that I have yet to explore.



photo by tanja nixx

What worked for you marketing-wise? What advice or tips would you give to new artists?

That's a great question. I have been in the biz since before YouTube. It wasn't easy then and it's not easy now. But there are ways to monetize your music, but you have to take it on as a full-time job to really reap the benefits that are available. Do your research, take a class, attend a workshop, connect with others in the field.

I market through email, social media, streaming platforms, retail platforms, music publications, radio, and I perform live. The old saying 'it takes money to make money' is 100%. So if you don't have money, you will have to take all this on as a full-time job yourself. That is why you really need to understand the industry and where you fit in. Marketing yourself as a rap artist will look very different than as a folk artist. If you have the resources, you can hire a team to do all these things. There are many talented individuals who can help you bring your vision to life. The music industry is probably one of the toughest to succeed in, and so far, even with the onslaught of streaming and other advanced technologies, it hasn't yet become any easier.

What do you think of AI in music?

Great music comes from the human heart. My electronic music self sees it as just another tool in the toolbox of creativity, but it should never be a substitute for human creativity. It is the human experience that makes music so important. As it is presently, it should not take the place of "authentic inspiration", the original AI. I have heard AI-generated songs, and they sound derivative and flat to me. The commercial corporate world will see AI as a way to not have to actually use/pay a musician/composer. And since commercial corporate music is derivative by design, more music jobs will be lost. Some folks say it helps them write, but AI is actually doing the writing, not the songwriter. Reading books of poetry and studying the great songwriters or composers will do that as well. And it will be more personally enriching. The best art comes from the blood, sweat, and tears of the artist, and takes time and hard work.

I don't think real human-generated music will ever stop, not as long as there is a guitar, piano, violin, clarinet, or drum to be played. One more thing to consider is that it is the power of the creative human brain that has developed and discovered things that advance civilization. Therefore, it is essential to keep our creative brains strong and not to rely too heavily on technology, so that our creative brains remain sharp.



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In the world of music streaming, where algorithms have become the silent conductors of our listening lives, Amazon Music has introduced a feature that seems almost self-reflective in its ambition. Subscribers across every tier can now access a monthly “Insights” recap, a carefully curated dossier of their own auditory habits. This is no mere chart of play counts; it is a window into the rhythms of individual taste, a badge of fidelity in a world of infinite choice. Users are treated to their most-played artists, their top tracks, the podcasts that punctuate their weeks, and, of course, the total minutes they’ve spent enveloped in sound. There is even a ceremonial flourish: the “Top Listener” badge, awarded to those whose ears have proven most devoted. One might imagine the subtle satisfaction this will grant the most ardent audiophiles, a private nod, a discreet tip of the hat from the platform itself. And Amazon is not done. Teasing additional celebrations and features later this year, the company hints at a future where listening becomes an act of both personal reflection and public celebration. In the end, it is a reminder that music consumption, even in its most digital form, is still a profoundly human experience: intimate, revealing, and, for those who engage with it deeply, deeply gratifying.

Yet, as the platforms refine the art of the personalised musical experience, they are also redefining the rules of participation. Instagram, that grand amphitheatre of ephemeral moments and curated spectacle, has quietly imposed a new barrier on its livestream function. Henceforth, only accounts that are public and boast a minimum of 1K followers may broadcast in real time. Meta frames this as a measure to reduce spam and improve the quality of live content.

But for smaller artists and creators, this is a sudden and jarring gatekeeping. Those who have cultivated their craft in relative obscurity, who have honed their performance in intimate digital spaces, now find themselves outside the circle, watching as numbers determine their access.

It is a reminder that in the digital age, audience size can eclipse artistic merit, and that even the most compelling voice may be muted if it fails to meet an arbitrary threshold. Instagram’s move is emblematic of a larger trend: the commodification of attention, the quantification of influence, and the subtle, almost imperceptible ways platforms shape the very act of creation itself. Meanwhile, Spotify, the perennial titan of streaming, is adjusting its own terms of engagement—though in a far more traditional sense: through pricing. Users in South Asia, Europe, Latin America, and potentially other regions may soon notice a modest increase in their Premium subscriptions,

toward a more immersive, narrative-driven form of entertainment. For \$11.99 per month, subscribers unlock 15 hours of audiobook content, with plan managers able to extend the same benefit to members of Duo or Family accounts. It is an elegant fusion of literary indulgence and digital convenience, a nod to the modern desire for knowledge, escape, and engagement in equal measure. In essence, Spotify is positioning itself not merely as a purveyor of music, but as a curator of personal culture, an indispensable companion in the private theatres of our minds. Taken together, these developments paint a picture of a streaming landscape in constant evolution. Amazon Music

the boundaries of participation, the economics of access, and the very nature of fandom itself. And amid all this, one cannot help but notice the quiet elegance of a feature like Amazon’s Insights, or the subtle social stratification implicit in Instagram’s new rules, or the cultured ambition of Spotify’s Audiobooks+. Together, they form a portrait of contemporary listening: attentive, curated, and unmistakably shaped by the platforms we inhabit.

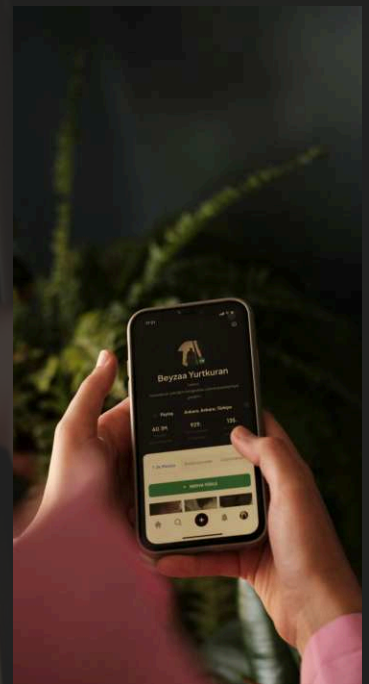
In the end, it is clear that the act of listening is no longer a private pleasure alone. It is measured, celebrated, restricted, and monetised. Yet, for those willing to navigate the evolving terrain, it offers a wealth of new pleasures, from badges and recaps to exclusive literary content, reminding us that the modern connoisseur of sound must be both discerning and adaptive. And perhaps, in this meticulously catalogued, algorithmically curated soundscape, there is a certain elegance to be found—not just in the music itself, but in the very act of listening.

Jay Jay

The Evolving Soundscape: Insights, Livestreams, and the Premium Experience

approximately €1 per month. While any increase in cost is greeted with a collective sigh from consumers, the implications are broader than mere economics. More revenue for Spotify inevitably translates to more resources for artists, more investment in content, and, perhaps, a subtle recalibration of the music industry at large. It is a reminder that in the world of digital music, dollars and cents are inseparable from art and influence. And yet, Spotify’s ambitions extend beyond music. Audiobooks+, its new feature rolled out to American users, marks a shift

reminds us that consumption can be celebratory, Instagram insists that creation is contingent on reach, and Spotify underscores that premium access is increasingly synonymous with broader, curated experiences. Each platform, in its own way, is negotiating the delicate balance between commerce, art, and personal connection, a reminder that in the digital era, music is as much about context as content. For the modern listener, these changes are far from trivial. They shape how we discover, engage with, and ultimately value music. They redefine





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